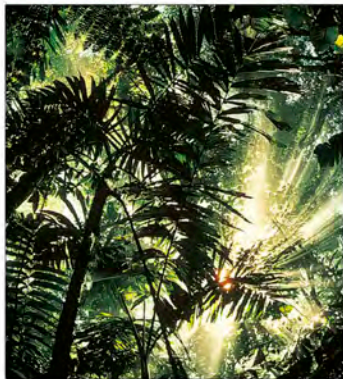


TROPICAL FORESTS

Giant trees, which seem to stretch to the sky, form a huge umbrella over the top of a tropical forest. In the shade beneath this green canopy live thousands of weird and wonderful birds. The hot, wet jungles are home to over half of the world's 10,000 species of birds. Noisy parrots gather fruit and nuts, colorful sunbirds sip the juice out of flowers, and harpy eagles swoop down on chattering monkeys.



When a toucan goes to sleep, it rests its big, brightly colored beak on its back.



Toco toucans are about 14 inches (35 cm) tall and live in South America.

This beak is not as heavy as it looks. It is hollow, and has thin rods of bone inside for strength and support.

The toucan uses the jagged edge of its beak like a saw to cut through large fruit.

Big stretch

With its long, clumsy-looking beak, the toucan can reach fruit and berries that are farther away. It picks them up and tosses them into its throat.